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ENG.112

8 Feb 2024

Annotated Bibliography

In this generation, teenagers have access to an extraordinary amount of technology. Due to this technology, many different forms of social media have been created that are widely and commonly used by teenagers across the world. Since there is such a vast number of social media apps and websites, it has become hard to regulate, and has even become a part of teenager's everyday lives. This bears the question; how does social media affect the mental health of teenagers? While there is a lot of positive content and material to view on social media, there is just as much negative and poor content that are being watched by teenagers. Along with the content, other teenagers sometimes use social media to bully kids online, causing negative effects on these children's mental health, which explains why the anxiety and depression rates for this generation have increased dramatically in the last decade. I chose to keep the citations in APA format to keep consistent to the writing we have used this semester for the research assignments.

THE ANNIE E. CASEY FOUNDATION. (2023, August 10). *Social Media and Teen Mental Health*. The Annie E. Casey Foundation. <https://www.aecf.org/blog/social-medias-concerning-effect-on-teen-mental-health#:~:text=Numer>

ous%20studies%20show%20that%20higher,poor%20body%20image%2C%20eating%20disorder

Annie Casey published this article to her blog named The Annie E. Casey Foundation. Casey's purpose is to inform parents and teenagers of the warnings on negative effects of social media usage on the mental health of teenagers. They concluded that social media usage has many negative effects on the mental health of teenagers. After many studies they found that 95% of adolescents ages 13 - 17 use social media. They concluded that kids who use social media for more than three hours per day, experience twice the risk of poor mental health outcomes. Along with that, a recent survey confirmed that 8th - 10th graders spend an average of 3 - 5 hours on social media per day. Dangers of social media that can cause these mental health downswings include adolescents being exposed to hate - based content on social media. This source connects to my topic because it shows the negative effects on how social media usage correlates to teenage mental health.

Khalaf, A. M., Alubied, A. A., Khalaf, A. M., & Rifaey, A. A. (2023). The Impact of Social Media on the Mental Health of Adolescents and Young Adults: a Systematic Review. *Cureus*, 15(8). <https://doi.org/10.7759/cureus.42990>

Alexander Muacevic published this article to the National Library of Medicine. Alexander's purpose of writing this article was to inform parents and adolescents of the different types of social media, including the exact platforms used and how popular they are. Alexander is also providing information on how these platforms affect adolescent behavior and mental health.

Alexander explained the many different risk factors that teenagers are facing, including family issues, bullying/cyberbullying, and social isolation. It is explained that social media is the “norm” in a teenager’s life. Many teenagers feel they can’t live life without social media because of how connected they are with peers through these platforms. Alexander concluded that although there is a “generally correlated” link between social media use and depression, the outcomes have been inconsistent, and the data quality is frequently poor. This opposes my conclusion that social media has negative effects on teenagers' mental health because it explains that the data is not sufficient enough to show that there is a direct correlation between social media usage and poor mental health among teenagers.

Schønning, V., Hjetland, G. J., Aarø, L. E., & Skogen, J. C. (2020). Social Media Use and Mental Health and Well-Being Among Adolescents – A Scoping Review. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 11(1949). <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2020.01949>

This article was published to a blog/forum and was written by many different authors including Viktor Schonning, Gunnhild Hjetland, Leif Aaro, and Jens Skogen. These authors wrote this article together for the purpose of attempting to concluded on the correlation between mental health and social media usage among teenagers. The authors used a specific research technique involving certain keywords in

google searches relating to negative and positive outcomes involving social media and mental health. According to their research, about 3/4 of the searches were negative keywords and therefore, related to a negative outlook on the correlation of the two topics. Keywords commonly

found in these searches included cyberbullying, depression, and many different substances. The authors concluded that positive association between mental health and social media was rare, and that a negative association was much more common, which supports my conclusion on the poor effect of social media usage on teenagers.

Murez, C. (2023, August 21). *Social Media Is Parents' Top Concern as Kids Head Back to School: Poll*. Wwww.healthday.com. <https://www.healthday.com/health-news/public-health/social-media-2663996912.html#:~:text=Mental%20and%20emotional%20health%20were>

Cara Murez published this article to a forum/blog website by the name of health day. Murez' purpose of the article is to give a perspective from parents on the issue of mental health in regard to social media usage among teenagers. Key takeaways from Murez' findings, is that besides the overall screen time, parents are worried about how social media influences their children's self-esteem. Other parents in worse financial situations are worried about how social media affects school violence, drinking and drugs, and teen pregnancy. Parents struggle how to regulate the usage of social media, and 2/3 of parents have reported that stress, anxiety, suicide, depression, bullying, and related topics have been directly observed in association with social media. Along with these findings, at least half of the parents agreed that they we're concerned about the lack of mental health services for their children. This article continues to further prove my conclusion that social media usage among teenagers has a serious and negative affect on their mental health and has caused an inexcusable amount of grief for all parties involved.

Mars Hill University Renfro Library: Proxy Login. (n.d.). Login.proxy103.Nclive.org. Retrieved May 2, 2024, from

<https://www.proquest.com/docview/1718295985?parentSessionId=9J8vZeoW364EfYNTVmDS TIpgupXUhVQS9IvZvwV9kSk%3D&pq-origsite=summon&accountid=12280&sourcetype=Scholarly%20Journals>

Gagan Deep published this peer reviewed journal to the ProQuest website. This journal, named the Indian journal of Health and Wellbeing was written with a purpose to explain the reasons this generation has become consumed by social media and the internet itself. Deep states, “Internet today has become an integral part of our lives. We simply can't think of the smooth flow of our daily routines without internet.” Deep also states, “Further, the ability to interact with others is the unique feature of social media, which provides powerful new ways for teens to create and navigate their personal and social behaviors. The main factors which affect the behavior of teenagers on social media are their developing identity, emerging sexuality, physical development, and moral consciousness.” Deep gives these quotes to explain that teenagers nowadays use internet so frequently and unconsciously. Teenagers have become addicted to the internet, literally using it at all times and for almost every task. This has started to take a toll on kid’s mental health. They are experiencing the same problems that drug addicts experience, only with the internet. This causes kids minds being changed and brainwashed, subconsciously causing anxiety and stresses.

Mars Hill University Renfro Library: Proxy Login. (n.d.). Login.proxy103.Nclive.org. Retrieved May 2, 2024, from

<https://www.proquest.com/docview/2778065718?parentSessionId=JOUnh%2Bp2fx%2BHCFoAQem6duKYtMw558osLaTbmGQdXH8%3D&pq-origsite=summon&accountid=12280&sourcetype=Scholarly%20Journals>

Amy Orben and Sarah Jayne-Blakemore published this peer review article to the ProQuest website. The purpose of this journal is to explain a missing link on how social media affects teens' mental health. Orben and Blakemore explain in their abstract a fascinating statistic about teenager's life satisfaction and their social media usage. From Orben's studies, she found that there is almost a direct correlation between amount of social media usage and reported life satisfaction levels. In other words, people who use more social media report that they are less happy in life. Orben writes, "For some people, being able to constantly track feedback from peers could heighten anxieties about self-worth or amplify the impact of judgements from peers. Some researchers have proposed that digital innovations, such as games or social-media platforms including TikTok, might even impact adolescents' development of a sense of self, how they perceive others' opinions of them or what habits they develop around social-media use^{14,16,17}." Orben includes this data to explain the new poor mental health problems that have been reported present due to increased use of social media.

Mars Hill University Renfro Library: Proxy Login. (n.d.). Login.proxy103.Nclive.org. Retrieved May 2, 2024, from

<https://www.proquest.com/docview/2745720929?parentSessionId=FFHI%2B%2FhH%2FhgMXOQ%2BxLqWBje%2BMmM5VNeBlmRUrckZREE%3D&pq-origsite=summon&accountid=12280&sourcetype=Scholarly%20Journals>

Andrew Smith published the peer reviewed journal “Young users’ social media addiction: causes, consequences and preventions” to the ProQuest website. Smith’s purpose in this article is to explain the causes and effects of teens social media addiction, and also how to prevent the addiction from starting. Smith states, “Caplan proposed the theory of problematic Internet use and psychosocial well-being, explaining that individuals who exhibit signs of poor psychosocial health have a problematic relationship with the unique communicative context available in cyberspace.” Smith gives this exact quote to add yet another supportive piece of data to explain the negative correlation between teenagers being so acclimated to communicating and exploring social media. Smith continues by saying that the overuse of social media can lead to feelings of loneliness, depression, and shyness. Unlike the other sources, Smith gives ways to prevent these addictive symptoms. Smith explains that parents are the only ones who can control their teenager’s usage of social media to prevent these problems. Tactics such as limiting phone use and encouraging more social and outdoor activities should lure them away from yearning social media.

Gupta, S. (2024, February 20). *Social Media Harms Teens’ Mental health, Mounting Evidence shows. What now?* Science News. <https://www.sciencenews.org/article/social-media-teens-mental-health>

Sujata Gupta publishes the news article “Social Media harms teens’ mental health, mounting evidence shows. What Now? Gupta’s purpose is to show data on the correlation between social media usage and teenagers mental health, and steps to take after learning the data.

Similar to Amy Orben's peer review journal, Gupta states, "Social media use was associated with a drop in well-being among teens during certain developmental periods, chiefly puberty and young adulthood, the team reported in 2022 in *Nature Communications*. That translated to lower well-being scores around ages 11 to 13 for girls and ages 14 to 15 for boys. Both groups also reported a drop in well-being around age 19." With this quote, Gupta gives more evidence to prove Orben's theory correct, that based on self-reports and surveys, all teenagers have admitted to lower happiness and life satisfaction. Gupta also highlights how research from 10 years ago wasn't as strong in showing and proving the negative correlation between social media and mental health but rebuts this statement by explaining how creation and usage of social media among teenagers has exponentially increased since the research conducted a decade ago, stating that 60% of teens report being on multiple social media platforms. Gupta gives sufficient evidence proving the negative correlation.

Seals, D. (2022, October 29). How Social Media affects your Mental Health [Review of *How Social Media affects your Mental Health*]. *Boss Magazine*. <https://thebossmagazine.com/how-social-media-affects-mental-health/#:~:text=Psychological%20Consequences%20of%20Social%20Media%20on%20Mental%20Health&text=This%20can%20lead%20to%20unrealistic,of%20envy%2C%20depression%20or%20anxiety>.

Devin Seals publishes this magazine article to Boss Magazine. Seals wrote and edited this article to inform the general public to be aware of the potential harms associates with social media use, both psychologically and with regards to mental health disorders. Seals takes a

different approach to addressing the consequences by using more feelings and reported types of low life satisfaction, as an attempt to help teenagers and parents further understand the dangers of social media usage. Seals states, “This can lead to unrealistic body image expectations, low self-esteem, and a preoccupation with physical appearance. As a result, individuals may. Egon to compare themselves to others, leading to feelings of envy, depression, or anxiety. In addition to creating and perpetuating unrealistic life and beauty standards, social media can also create feelings of loneliness. Much has been said about “online loneliness, and while it is not always a direct result of social media use, it can be an unfortunate by-product.” Seals gives direct feelings in her evidence of the negative correlation between the overuse of social media and mental health in a similar way to Andrew Smith did in his peer reviewed journal. Seals does this to help the younger generation relate to the feeling words, and better understand the problem at hand.

Orlowski, J. (2020). The Social Dilemma [Documentary]. In *Netflix*.

John Orlowski writes and directed this Netflix documentary, exploring the dark side of social media and its impact on society. Orlowski’s purpose was to expose the truth behind the dark side of social media, and to release this information to open the eyes of people who don’t understand these issues are present in many teenagers around the world, in hopes of making a change. The film is commonly praised for its portrayal of how severe the addictive effects of social media can be, and, by featuring insiders, exposing to a wide audience, the strategies to increase usage and data extraction at play by tech companies. Unlike all other articles explaining the causes and effects of social media addiction, Orlowski highlights how much the tech companies and social media companies play a part in the birth of the social media addiction present in teenagers. These companies purposely create algorithms to keep you locked into the

content they show you, by creatively showing you content based on how much of a certain type of content you enjoy. Companies can be blamed for singlehandedly creating the exponential rise in lessened mental health due to social media usage. These tech companies are extraditing our children to make as much money as they can. This exact reason is Orlowski's purpose for the film, with hopes to make a change and bring awareness to the growing problem between social media abuse and low mental health among teenagers.

